

AI-First ESP Design Recommendation

Overview

This document provides a structured design recommendation for a new AI-native email service provider (ESP). It draws from research into leading ESPs and emphasizes AI-assisted workflows, a clear navigation model and a flexible data model to support advanced marketing automation.

Navigation & Menu Structure

The application should use a persistent left-hand sidebar to organize features logically. Suggested top-level items include:

1. **Overview** – a home dashboard with key metrics and AI insights. This page surfaces total sends, open/click rates and revenue, and shows AI-generated suggestions for optimal send times and churn-risk segments (similar to AI insights and send-time optimization used by Constant Contact and Brevo ¹ ²).
2. **Campaigns** – entry point for creating and managing email/SMS campaigns. The campaign builder should include a prompt-driven AI assistant that generates subject lines and content (akin to ActiveCampaign's AI builder ³), a drag-and-drop editor and send-time optimization ² .
3. **Automations** – a visual journey builder where users assemble triggers, conditions and actions. AI suggests next steps and recommended segments ⁴ .
4. **Audience** – contact management and segmentation. Includes an AI-powered segment builder that turns natural-language descriptions into filtering rules ⁵ .
5. **Templates** – library of reusable email templates and saved blocks. Supports global styles and AI-generated variants.
6. **AI Studio** – a hub for generative tools (content creation, image remixing, product recommendations), drawing on AI features found in Constant Contact, Brevo and GetResponse ¹ ² ⁶ .
7. **Analytics** – interactive reports with deliverability metrics, engagement funnels and ROI. Includes an AI insights panel to highlight trends.
8. **Integrations** – management of connectors to e-commerce platforms, CRMs, data warehouses, and third-party tools.
9. **Settings** – account management, user roles, domain authentication (DKIM/SPF), compliance tools and developer APIs.

Key Pages & Workflows

1. **Dashboard**: The landing page displays metric cards (e.g., revenue, sends, opens, clicks) and visualizations such as line charts. An AI insights widget suggests next actions (e.g., re-engage lapsed subscribers). Quick access to recent campaigns and automations.

2. **Campaign Builder:** A wizard with steps (Create → Audience → Content → Review). Users describe the campaign intent; AI generates subject lines and body copy. A drag-and-drop editor allows fine-tuning. In the Audience step, AI recommends segments based on past engagement ⁴.
3. **Automation Builder:** A flow editor where triggers, conditions and actions are connected visually. Users can insert waits, splits and goals. An AI suggestions panel recommends additional branches or tags to optimize the workflow. Advanced features include send-time testing and A/B branching.
4. **Segment Creation:** From the Audience module, users describe a target segment in plain language. AI converts this to a dynamic segment rule set (similar to Klaviyo's AI-powered segmentation ⁵). Predictive metrics (size, churn risk, CLV) appear before saving.
5. **AI Studio:** Hosts tools for content generation (subject lines, copy), product recommendations and image editing. It also offers "best send time" and "best send day" analyses using historical patterns.

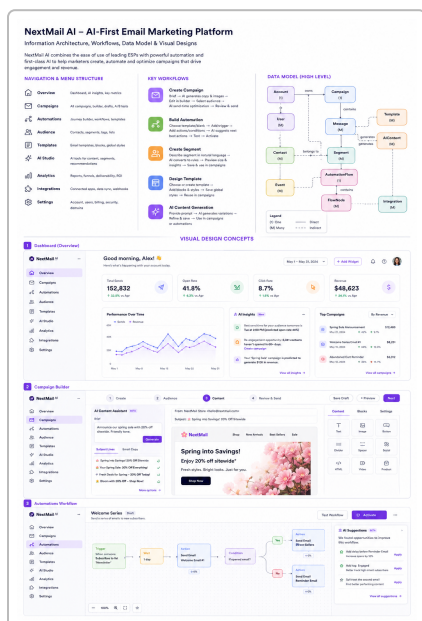
Data Model (High-Level)

- **Account:** Organization using the ESP; stores subscription and billing details.
- **User:** Members of an account with roles and permissions.
- **Contact:** Individual recipient with metadata (email, phone, demographics) and event history.
- **Segment:** Dynamic or static set of contacts defined by rules or AI queries; includes predictive scores (churn risk, lifetime value).
- **Campaign:** Object containing campaign metadata, target segments, messages and results.
- **Message:** Email/SMS content with subject, body, template and send schedule; linked to AI content prompts.
- **AutomationFlow:** Workflow definition containing nodes (triggers, conditions, actions) and connections.
- **Template:** Saved layouts and design blocks with global styles.
- **AIContent:** Records prompts and generated outputs for training and auditing.
- **Event:** Log of interactions (sends, opens, clicks, purchases) linked to contacts and campaigns.
- **Integration:** Third-party connections with settings and field mappings.

Sample Visual Designs

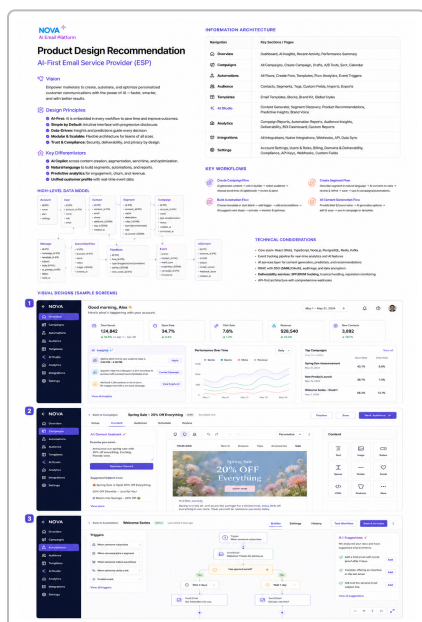
The following images illustrate three sample designs for the navigation and primary pages. Each design uses a light or dark pastel color palette, a left-hand navigation bar and AI-centric panels.

Design 1: Overview Dashboard



Features: Left navigation with modules; metric cards for revenue, sends, opens and clicks; line charts showing performance trends; an AI insights panel recommending the optimal send time and identifying churn-risk segments. This page is analogous to the dashboards used by leading ESPs to surface high-level performance metrics and AI suggestions ¹ ².

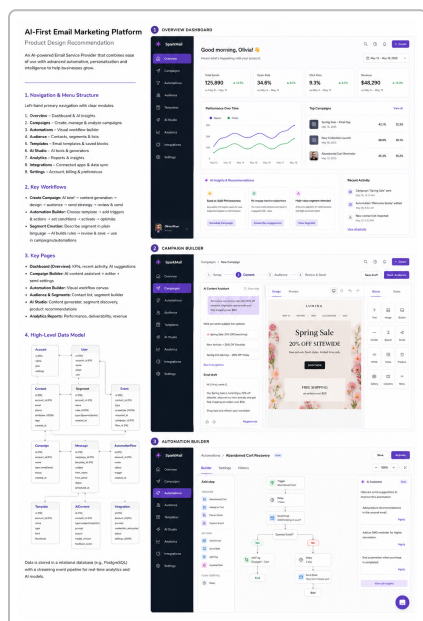
Design 2: Campaign Builder



Features: A step-by-step wizard (Create → Audience → Content → Review). The current content step includes an AI content assistant that proposes subject lines and body copy based on a short brief; users can

regenerate or edit the output. The drag-and-drop editor on the right allows adding text, images and buttons. This page captures the ease of use found in Mailchimp and Constant Contact editors while adding AI content generation and send-time optimization 7 1 .

Design 3: Automation Workflow



Features: The Automations module presents a visual flow editor. Users can drag triggers, conditions, waits and actions onto a canvas to build complex journeys. An AI suggestions panel proposes additional branches or tags, helping marketers optimize their workflows 4 . The dark mode variant underscores the flexibility of the UI while maintaining readability.

Conclusion

These designs synthesize best practices from top ESPs with AI-native capabilities. A clear navigation structure, AI-assisted workflows and a scalable data model provide a foundation for an ESP that is both powerful and easy to use. The sample designs demonstrate how AI insights and content creation tools can be woven into the user interface to improve efficiency and decision making.

1 Constant Contact Review and Pricing in 2026

<https://www.business.com/reviews/constant-contact/>

2 Email Marketing Features – Design, Send & Analyze | Brevo

<https://www.brevo.com/features/email-marketing/>

3 4 ActiveCampaign AI Suite: Active Intelligence Helps You Create, Automate, Organize, and Strategize! | ActiveCampaign

<https://www.activecampaign.com/learn/videos/activecampaign-ai-suite-create-automate-organize-and-strategize>

5 AI for Email Marketing - Klaviyo

<https://www.klaviyo.com/solutions/ai/email-marketing>

6 GetResponse Review 2026 - The Right Tool for Your Business?

<https://www.emailtooltester.com/en/reviews/getresponse/>

7 Mailchimp Email Marketing Review

<https://www.business.com/reviews/mailchimp/>